

# Max Posch

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## APPOINTMENTS

*University of Exeter, Department of Economics, Lecturer (Assistant Professor).* since 2022  
*Harvard University, Department of Human Evolutionary Biology, Research Associate.* since 2022  
*University of Chicago Booth School of Business, Stigler Center Affiliate Fellow.* since 2025

## PAST APPOINTMENTS

*Harvard University, Department of Human Evolutionary Biology, Postdoctoral Fellow.* 2020-2022

## EDUCATION

*University of Zurich, Ph.D. in Economics.* 2014-2020  
*Barcelona Graduate School of Economics, M.Sc in Economics.* 2013  
*University of St. Gallen, Bachelor's Degree in International Affairs.* 2012  
*University of St. Gallen, Bachelor's Degree in Business Administration.* 2012

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Economic Development, Political Economy, Economic History, Cultural Evolution.

## PUBLICATIONS AND ACCEPTED PAPERS

*How Cultural Diversity Drives Innovation: Surnames and Patents in U.S. History.* (with Jonathan Schulz and Joseph Henrich). **Journal of Political Economy**, 2026; 134 (4): 1245-1305.

*The Political Economy of Propaganda: Evidence from U.S. Newspapers.* (with Sebastian Ottinger). **Journal of the European Economic Association**, Accepted

## WORKING PAPERS

*On the Importance of African Traditional Religion for Economic Behavior.* (with Lewis Dunia Butinda, Aimable Amani Lameke, Nathan Nunn, and Raul Sanchez de la Sierra). **Econometrica**, Reject and Resubmit

*Doux Commerce: Markets, Culture and Cooperation in 1850-1920 U.S.* (with Tzachi Raz)

*Do Disasters Affect the Tightness of Social Norms?*

## WORK IN PROGRESS

*Cultural Change: Evidence from 300 Years of U.S. Local Newspapers.*

*Surname Relatedness and the Diffusion of Innovation.* (with Jonathan Schulz and Joseph Henrich)

*Innovation and the Medieval Church.* (with Slava Savitskiy, Jonathan Schulz and Joseph Henrich)

## RESEARCH FUNDING

*Collective Brains: How Markets, Trade, Religions and Geography Drive Creativity* 2027-2030

John Templeton Foundation. Co-Principal Investigator (with Michael Muthukrishna, New York University). \$3.48m.

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <i>Religiosity: Evidence from 300 Years of U.S. Local Newspapers</i>                                                                                   | 2023-2026 |
| Principal Investigator. British Academy/Leverhulme Small Research Grant, £10,000 (2024-2026);<br>Templeton Religion Trust Mini Grant, \$10,000 (2023). |           |
| <i>Psychological Change: Evidence from 300 Years of U.S. Local Newspapers</i>                                                                          | 2022      |
| Mind Brain Behavior Initiative, Harvard University (with Joseph Henrich and Anke Becker). \$50,000.                                                    |           |

## AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

|                                                |           |
|------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Fellow of Advance HE (FHEA).                   | 2024      |
| Dissertation Fellowship, University of Zurich. | 2019-2020 |
| SNF Doc.Mobility Grant.                        | 2018-2019 |
| Swiss Study Foundation Scholarship.            | 2014-2019 |

## TEACHING AND SUPERVISION

|                                                                               |            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| <i>Economics of Culture and Institutions (undergraduate)</i>                  | since 2023 |
| Module convenor and lecturer, University of Exeter                            |            |
| <i>Microeconomics II (undergraduate)</i>                                      | since 2022 |
| Module convenor and lecturer, University of Exeter                            |            |
| <i>Dissertation supervision (MSc and undergraduate), University of Exeter</i> | since 2023 |
| <i>Programming Practices for Research in Economics (graduate)</i>             | 2016, 2017 |
| Lecturer, University of Zurich                                                |            |
| <i>Program Evaluation and Causal Inference (graduate)</i>                     | 2016, 2017 |
| Teaching Assistant for Prof. Pietro Biroli, University of Zurich.             |            |
| <i>Development Economics (undergraduate)</i>                                  | 2015       |
| Teaching Assistant for Prof. Joachim Voth, University of Zurich.              |            |

## ACADEMIC SERVICE

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| <i>Founder and organiser, DEPIC reading group, University of Exeter</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | since 2026 |
| Development, Environment, Political Economy, Institutions and Culture. Monthly group combining discussion of frontier working papers with presentations of work in progress.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |            |
| <i>Co-organiser, "Origins and Consequences of Group Identities" workshop, University of Zurich</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 2017       |
| Two-day international workshop, co-organised with Kai Gehring and Bruno Caprettini.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |            |
| <i>Discussant:</i> Workshop in Economic History, Uppsala University (2025); ASSA Meetings, "Culture" session (2022); Origins and Consequences of Group Identities, University of Zurich (2017).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |            |
| <i>Refereeing:</i> American Economic Review; Quarterly Journal of Economics; Review of Economic Studies; Journal of the European Economic Association; Economic Journal; Journal of Economic History; Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization; Experimental Economics; Journal of Urban Economics; Nature Human Behavior; Nature Climate Change; PNAS Nexus; Evolutionary Human Sciences. |            |

## SEMINAR AND CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

*Scheduled:* ASREC Europe conference; Stigler Center Affiliate Fellows Conference; WZB conference on migration and diversity. 2026: Belfast workshop; Birmingham workshop; BSE Forum; Koç; NICEP Conference; Oxford; Queen Mary U; SIOE conference; U. of Southern Denmark; York. 2025: ASREC Thematic Conference; Bristol Meeting on Development Economics; Brown (Deep-Rooted Factors in Comparative Development Conference); Cambridge; CEPR Workshop Ethnicity, Identity and Conflict; King's College London; Lugano; PPE Society

Annual Meeting; Stigler Center Affiliate Fellows Conference; Transatlantic Political Economy Conference; TU Munich (Workshop on Cultural Economics and Economic History); Université Paris 1; Uppsala (Workshop in Economic History). 2024: AFE conference; ASREC Europe conference; Bristol; BSE Forum; Calgary Workshop; Copenhagen; ESEM conference; ERINN workshop; Leicester; Lund; Lyon; NBER Summer Institute; NICEP Conference; Newcastle; Odense; SIOE conference, Warwick. 2023: Prague; NBER Summer Institute; CEPR Media, Technology, Politics, and Society Conference; CEPR Big Counterfactuals of Macro-Political History Conference; NICEP Conference; ASREC US Conference; Ifo Media Bias Workshop; SPSP Pre-Conference; ASSA Conference. 2022: GMU seminar; NYU seminar; ASREC US Conference; EEA-ESEM conference. 2021: Bonn; Brown; Cliometrics; EEA-ESEM; ETH; New South Wales; NOBEC; Nottingham. 2020: EHA; Florida State; Harvard. 2019: ASREC US; Brown; ETH; Harvard.

## **MEDIA AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT**

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <i>Forbes</i> , “Immigration And Diverse Populace Made America An Innovation Superpower”   | 2023 |
| <i>Marginal Revolution</i> and <i>National Affairs</i> , on <i>Doux Commerce</i>           | 2025 |
| <i>Broadstreet</i> , on <i>The Political Economy of Propaganda</i>                         | 2025 |
| <i>Becker Friedman Institute</i> , research summary on <i>African Traditional Religion</i> | 2024 |